

State of Alaska – Office of the Governor — 34th Alaska State Legislature – Second Session
DEPARTMENT REVIEW – PASSED LEGISLATION

BLUE SHEET

Blue Sheets are a department's final bill analysis and provides the Commissioner an opportunity to weigh in on legislation that has passed, with a recommendation to the Governor on action that may be taken– to enact the bill, to veto the bill, or to allow the bill to become Law without signature (LWOS). Much of the information requested in the Blue Sheet can be taken from the department's bill analysis (BA), which were initially submitted at the time the bill was introduced and updated throughout the legislative process.

Blue sheets are due to the GLO three days after the enrolled bill appears on basis, or sooner by request.

Department: DFG

Date: 5/26/2026

Bill Number: SB230

Short Title (as it appears on BASIS): REFUGES/HABITAT AREAS/PUBLIC USE AREA

What action do you recommend the Governor take?

Select one.

☒ SIGN ☐ VETO ☐ LWOS

Action Justification – Why do you recommend the above action?

ADF&G recommends this bill become law with signature. SB 230, as passed, is primarily a Department of Natural Resources bill revising and expanding descriptions of state refuges, critical habitat areas, and the Jonesville Public Use Area. However, during the legislative process, the House Resources Committee incorporated portions of HB 321, which triggered ADF&G involvement because the department had previously submitted a zero fiscal note for HB 321.

The final House CS (HCS SB 230(RES)) includes updates to multiple statutes under AS 16.20, which fall within ADF&G's statutory responsibilities for managing state refuges and critical habitat areas. These updates primarily modernize legal descriptions, clarify boundaries, and correct survey references. The bill does not impose new operational mandates on ADF&G, nor does it authorize new programs or regulatory requirements beyond existing responsibilities. Because the HB 321 language incorporated into SB 230 maintains the same scope previously reviewed by ADF&G, and the department determined those impacts could be absorbed with existing staff and resources, the zero fiscal note remains accurate. The department remains neutral on the legislation.

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Allowing SB 230 to become law with signature is appropriate, given that the bill updates statutory land descriptions, harmonizes refuge boundaries, incorporates previously reviewed language, and has no negative operational or fiscal impacts on ADF&G.

What does this Bill do?

In addition to providing a succinct bill summary, please also consider the following: Why is this bill needed? How does it specifically change department programs? What is the anticipated impact on the public, the private sector? Does this bill align with the priorities of Governor Dunleavy?

SB 230 (HCS SB 230(RES)) makes extensive statutory updates to AS 16.20 related to state game refuges, fish and game critical habitat areas, and associated tide and submerged lands. The bill also amends statutory land descriptions for the Jonesville Public Use Area under AS 41.23.286. These changes include:

- Updating or expanding legal land descriptions within several state refuges and critical habitat areas.
- Correcting outdated survey and township references.
- Clarifying the range of included land and water, particularly tide and submerged lands.
- Incorporating the HB 321 provisions into the broader SB 230 statutory package.

These statutory updates significantly improve the accuracy, consistency, and enforceability of refuge and critical habitat area boundaries by correcting legal descriptions—many of which were outdated, incomplete, or no longer aligned with current land surveys. ADF&G can absorb all responsibilities associated with these updates using existing staff and resources, and the bill does not require new positions, funding, or operational capacity. This is consistent with the department’s previously submitted zero fiscal note for the HB 321 provisions incorporated into SB 230. The clarifications provided in the bill also benefit land users, local governments, industry, and the public by ensuring that refuge and habitat area boundaries are clearly defined in statute. Importantly, the bill imposes no new restrictions on the public and does not create mandates for private businesses.

Detailed Sectional Analysis

The full sectional analysis of the bill should be completed by the lead agency. Other departments should include an analysis for sections of the bill affecting their agencies.

Sections 1–3: Updates the legal boundary descriptions and coordinates for the Izembek Refuge.

Section 4: Updates the legal land descriptions for the Palmer Hay Flats State Game Refuge.

Sections 5–9: Modernizes the statutory boundaries and survey references for the Port Moller, Egegik, Pilot Point, Fox River Flats, and Kachemak Bay Critical Habitat Areas.

Section 10: Amends AS 41.23.286 to update the statutory boundary description of the Jonesville Public Use Area.

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Sections 11–13: Establishes effective dates for the various sections of the Act.

Companion or Similar Bills

Please note companion legislation, the sponsor of the companion legislation, and identify any “rider” bills or provisions from other legislation that was included in this final bill. Please include the name of the sponsor of the “rider bill” or provision. If it was added as an amendment in a committee – please indicate the name of the legislator that sponsored the amendment.

N/A

Support/Opposition of the Bill

Please identify names, organizations, titles, and phone numbers of those who testified in support or in opposition of this bill.

SB 230 – REFUGES / HABITAT AREAS / PUBLIC USE AREA

Support:

N/A

Opposition:

N/A

HB 321 – FISH & GAME WILDLIFE REFUGES

Support: Norm Carson; Shirley Perkins; Alliance of Sovereign Tribes of Southeast Alaska; Homer Fish and Game Advisory Committee (Douglas Malone); Tami Mulick; Lance Kronerger; Cabot Pitts; R Seal; Steve Miller; Mike Wood; Kurt Whitehead; City of Craig (Kasey Smith); Ellen Hannan; City of Coffman Cove (Jack Mulcare); Organized Village of Kasaan (Michael Jones); Petersburg Flying Service LLC (Scott Newman); Joseph Johnson; Brian Castle; Central Council of the Tlingit and Haida Indian Tribes of Alaska (Richard Peterson); Wrangell Fish and Game Advisory Committee (Chris Guggenbickler); Mary Corcoran; Delta Sportsmen’s Association (Vern Aiton); Elijah Winrod; Lena Hensley; Mark Tollfeldt; Leif Wilson; Doug Rhodes; Michael Kampnich; Tanana Chiefs Conference (Brian Ridley); East Prince of Wales Island Fish and Game Advisory Committee (Amy Jennings); Jacob Combs; Colonel David Egeleston.

Opposition: Resident Hunters of Alaska (Mark Richards); Bret Bradford; Gary Hollier

Bill Signing ceremony suggestions (if applicable)

Please provide information for consideration for a bill signing ceremony. Information that is helpful includes: a specific conference, event, venue, date, and the names and contact information of stakeholders who should be considered for an invitation to the bill signing ceremony.

N/A

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Commissioner's Signature: _____ **Date:** 5/26/2026

I have reviewed the above information and provided it to the Governor's Legislative Office for consideration of an action by the Governor on legislation passed during the second session of the 34th Alaska State Legislature.

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